CWS CHILLWITHSYD

Enshrouded Server Manager
Owner's Manual

A complete guide to installing, running, and looking after your own Enshrouded dedicated server — written for first-time server owners, from unzip to your first backup.

v1.0 Windows Steam App 2278520

chillwithsyd

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1. Welcome

What this is, and what it takes care of for you.

The **ChillWithSyd Enshrouded Server Manager** is a small program that runs on a Windows PC and gives you a browser-based control panel for hosting your own **Enshrouded** dedicated server — the kind you and your friends can play on together without anyone needing to stay in a hosted world while the host is offline.

Before this existed, running an Enshrouded dedicated server meant installing SteamCMD by hand, editing a JSON configuration file with duration values written out in nanoseconds, and hoping you didn't fat-finger a setting. The manager wraps all of that in a normal web page: buttons for start/stop/restart, a form-based config editor, one-click SteamCMD installs and updates, scheduled backups, and a log viewer — all served locally from `http://localhost:8790` on the PC that's hosting the game.

WHAT YOU DON'T NEED

No PowerShell, no admin rights, no command line, and — if you're using the release download — no separate Node.js install either. Everything the release build needs is already inside the one `.exe` file.

What this manual covers

This manual walks through the whole lifecycle: getting the manager installed, running Quick Setup to stand up your first server, opening the right ports so friends outside your house can actually reach you, and the day-to-day tools (dashboard, config, backups, logs) you'll come back to afterwards. It finishes with troubleshooting, a list of things Enshrouded itself simply doesn't support yet (so you're not left wondering if the panel is broken), an FAQ, and reference appendices for every gameplay setting and every default path.

Anywhere you see a box like the ones below, it's worth pausing on:

TIP

Something that makes life easier, but isn't required.

NOTE

Extra context or a detail worth knowing.

CAREFUL

A common mistake, or something with a real (but recoverable) downside.

SECURITY

Something that matters for keeping your server — and your PC — safe once it's reachable from the internet.

2. Before You Begin

A few things worth knowing before you unzip anything.

2.1 What you need

- A **Windows** PC — the Enshrouded dedicated server itself is Windows-only, so this has to run on Windows even if you administer it from a phone or Mac browser.
- **Internet access** on that PC, for the initial SteamCMD/game download and for keeping the server updated afterwards.
- Ideally, a PC that can stay on and connected for as long as you want the server reachable. A laptop that sleeps when the lid closes, or a PC on a schedule that shuts it off overnight, will take your server offline with it.

2.2 Recommended hardware

Keen Games hasn't published official minimum-spec numbers for the dedicated server binary itself, but figures repeated across several hosting providers give a reasonable planning target:

PLAYERS	CPU	RAM	DISK	BANDWIDTH
Idle / empty	—	~4.4 GB	~13 GB install; 30 GB free recommended so Steam updates have room to stage. Use an SSD — the world save system is disk-I/O sensitive.	~2 Mbit/s upload per connected player (recommend matching download)
4–6 players	6-core / 12-thread, ~3.2 GHz+	~5 GB		
16 players (max)	8-core / 16-thread, ~3.7 GHz+	~6 GB		

> **NOTE**
>
> Enshrouded rewards fast individual cores over sheer core count — a higher clock speed matters more than piling on threads. 16 players is a hard ceiling; the config's `slotCount` field won't accept more.

2.3 Check your network situation

If you only ever plan to play with people already on your home network (e.g. splitscreen-style, everyone on the same Wi-Fi), you can skip ahead — Section 6 is where the actual server controls live. If anyone will connect *from outside your house*, there's one thing worth checking now, because it can save you an hour of confused port-forwarding later:

> **CAREFUL — CARRIER-GRADE NAT (CGNAT)**
>
> Some ISPs (common on mobile broadband, and increasingly on residential fibre/cable too) put multiple customers behind a single shared public IP address. If that's your connection, **no amount of correct port forwarding will work** — the router simply doesn't have a public IP of its own to forward on. To check: compare your router's reported WAN/internet IP (in its admin page) against what a site like *whatismyipaddress.com* shows from a device on that same network. If they don't match, or your WAN IP falls in the `100.64.0.0` – `100.127.255.255` range, you're behind CGNAT. The usual fixes are asking your ISP for a "public IP" add-on (some offer this on request or for a small fee), or routing your server's traffic through a tunnelling service. This is worth ruling out *before* Quick Setup, not after friends can't connect.

3. Installing the Manager

Two ways to run it — pick the one that matches what you downloaded.

3.1 Release download (recommended for most people)

1. Download the release and copy the whole folder onto the Windows machine that will host the server — Desktop, Documents, wherever you like. It should contain `EnshroudedServerManager.exe` alongside `Enshrouded Server Manager.vbs`, `Stop Server Manager.vbs`, and a visible-window `.bat` alternative.
2. Double-click **Enshrouded Server Manager.vbs**. No console window appears — it starts completely in the background and opens your default browser automatically once it's ready.
3. You'll land on the **Quick Setup** tab, covered in the next section.

> **WHY A .VBS FILE?**
>
> Double-clicking a `.exe` directly would leave a black console window open for as long as the server manager runs. The `.vbs` launcher starts it fully hidden instead, and redirects its output to `data\manager.log` so that even a crash before the window would have appeared still leaves you a readable trail.

3.2 Running from source instead

If you're working from the project's source code rather than a release download, the same `.vbs` / `.bat` launchers detect that `EnshroudedServerManager.exe` isn't present next to them and fall back automatically: they check for Node.js, run `npm install` the first time (a one-off, roughly minute-long step), then start the manager the normal way. Everything else in this manual behaves identically either way.

3.3 First launch, step by step

```
data\manager.log
ChillWithSyd Enshrouded Server Manager listening on http://localhost:8790
```

That single line is what a healthy startup looks like. Your browser should open to it automatically within a few seconds. If it doesn't:

- Check whether a browser window simply opened *behind* another one.
- Open `http://localhost:8790` manually in any browser on that same PC.
- If nothing responds after ~10 seconds, the launcher itself opens `data\manager.log` in Notepad automatically — see Section 11.

3.4 Stopping the manager vs. stopping the game — don't mix these up

This trips up almost everyone at least once, so it's worth being explicit:

ACTION	WHAT IT STOPS	HOW
Dashboard → Stop (in the browser)	Just the *game server* (`enshrouded_server.exe`) — players get disconnected, but the management panel itself keeps running so you can start it again.	A button inside the web UI
Stop Server Manager.vbs (double-click on the PC)	The *manager program itself* — the web panel disappears, `localhost:8790` stops responding. If the game server was running, it does *not* stop it on its own — the game process keeps going independently.	A file next to the manager

> **CAREFUL**
>
> If you want to fully shut everything down (e.g. before a Windows update reboot), stop the game server from the Dashboard *first*, then double-click **Stop Server Manager.vbs**. Stopping the manager alone can leave the actual game process running invisibly in the background.

3.5 Adopting an existing installation

Already running a server the old-fashioned way — a bare `enshrouded_server.exe` in a folder, launched by double-clicking a simple `.bat` file? You don't need to reinstall anything. The manager doesn't care how a server folder got there; it only cares about the **Install directory** path you point it at. Give it the folder you already have, and it will find your existing server and its settings on its own — and on the **Advanced → Setup / Install** tab, an **"Already running a server the old way?"** card can even work out that folder path for you.

1. **Stop your server the old way first.** Close the console window or stop the process started by your `.bat` file. Two copies of `enshrouded_server.exe` fighting over the same save files and network port at once will corrupt things — never run both at the same time.
2. Launch the manager (Section 3.1) and open the **Advanced → Setup / Install** tab.
3. In the import card near the top, either click **Choose File** and pick your old `.bat` file directly, or just open it in Notepad and paste its contents into the box. Click **Detect install folder**.
4. The manager reads through the file looking for a `cd` command or a full path in front of `enshrouded_server.exe`, and shows you what it found. Click the **Import this folder** button that appears.
5. The manager now checks that folder directly for both `enshrouded_server.exe` and `enshrouded_server.json`, and tells you plainly whether the import **succeeded** or **failed** — no guessing. On success, if the server had already been started at least once before, it shows you a quick preview of what it found: server name, query port, slot count, save directory, and gameplay preset, straight out of the real file. Nothing is overwritten just by importing — the manager only starts reading from and writing to that folder once you actually use it.
6. If your install folder ends in the standard `steamapps\common\<AppName>` shape — the layout SteamCMD creates on its own by default — the import also looks one level up for an existing `steamcmd.exe` and links that folder in too, so the SteamCMD & server install card further down this tab shows **SteamCMD installed: Yes** without you having to hunt for that folder yourself. If your setup doesn't match that shape, the import tells you so and points you at the SteamCMD directory field's own **Browse…** button instead.
7. Switch to **Advanced → Config** to see the full imported settings, exactly as they were.
8. Go to the **Dashboard** tab and use **Start** from now on instead of the old `.bat` file.

ALREADY KNOW THE FOLDER? SKIP THE .BAT FILE ENTIRELY

You don't need a `.bat` file to use this — every path field on this tab (Install directory, SteamCMD directory, Backup directory) has its own **Browse…** button that opens a normal Windows folder picker, so you never have to type a path out by hand at all. Pick the folder, then click the **Import existing install from this folder** button in the Paths card for the same check-and-report treatment.

WHEN DETECTION CAN'T FIND A FOLDER

A few older-style `.bat` files use `%~dp0` (shorthand for "the folder this file is sitting in"), or a plain `cd` with no drive letter — and a browser has no way to read a pasted file's real location back out of its text. When that happens, the result box tells you which subfolder the `.bat` file runs from (e.g. `steamapps\common\EnshroudedServer`) and gives you a **Browse for it…** button right there — click it, navigate to the folder your `.bat` file is actually saved in, then open into that named subfolder. Once you confirm the folder in the native picker, it's imported and checked automatically — no separate step needed.

WHAT ABOUT EXTRA FLAGS IN THE OLD .BAT FILE?

If your `.bat` file typed anything after `enshrouded_server.exe` — a custom port, say — the detector will point it out, but there's genuinely nothing to carry over: `enshrouded_server.exe` doesn't read command-line arguments at all, so that text in your old `.bat` file was already being ignored by the game itself. Anything you actually want to change (query port, slots, and so on) lives in **Advanced → Config** instead.

NOTHING TO LOSE

Pointing the manager at a new install directory doesn't touch any files by itself — it only starts reading from and writing to whatever's already there once you save settings or open a tab that needs them. If you want a safety net anyway, copy your whole existing server folder somewhere else first; it only takes a minute and means there's no way to lose progress while you get familiar with the new panel.

FIRST TIME BEING MANAGED?

If your existing installation has *never* been run yet (no `enshrouded_server.json` in the folder), the Config tab will show it as not found until you either run the server once from the Dashboard or use the Quick Setup wizard, both of which generate that file automatically.

4. Quick Setup — Your Server in One Click

The fastest path from a blank PC to a joinable server.

Quick Setup is the tab you land on when the manager first opens. It's designed to be safe to click even if you've already run it before — it just re-applies your settings and restarts things.

4.1 The form, field by field

FIELD	WHAT IT DOES
Server name	What shows up for your server in the Steam server browser. Defaults to "ChillWithSyd Enshrouded Server" — change it to something your friends will recognise.
Password	Shared with whoever you want to let in. This becomes the password for the manager's built-in **Admin** user group — see the warning in 4.3 below.
Player slots	1–16. Enshrouded's own hard ceiling is 16; there's no way to raise it.
Difficulty	Default, Relaxed, Hard, or Survival — one of Enshrouded's built-in presets. Pick **Custom** later, on the Config tab, if you want to hand-tune individual gameplay sliders instead (see Section 8.2).

4.2 What happens behind the scenes

Clicking **Install & Start My Server** runs through several steps automatically, all visible in the log box as they happen:

1. **SteamCMD install** (skipped if already installed) — a small (~10 MB) one-time download from Valve.
2. **Game server install/update** — downloads Steam app `2278520` (Enshrouded Dedicated Server) via anonymous login, no Steam account required. This step retries automatically a couple of times if SteamCMD reports a failure, since a freshly-extracted SteamCMD commonly needs to update itself before it can do anything else — you shouldn't normally need to click anything twice.
3. **First-run config generation** — Enshrouded doesn't write its own `enshrouded_server.json` until the exe has actually run once. Quick Setup starts the server briefly, waits for that file to appear (up to 45 seconds), then stops it again so it can safely edit it.
4. **Applies your settings** — name, slot count, difficulty preset, and the Admin group password, on top of whatever's already in the config.
5. **Starts the server for real.**

Expect the whole thing to take a few minutes the first time (mostly step 2, the actual game download) and well under a minute on any later run.

4.3 Passwords Quick Setup does *not* change

> **SECURITY — READ THIS BEFORE INVITING ANYONE**
>
> Quick Setup only sets the password for the first ("Admin") user group. The manager's default config also ships two more groups — **Friend** and **Guest** — with their own default passwords (`changeme-friend` and `changeme-guest`) that Quick Setup *leaves alone*. If you only ever use the one Admin password from Quick Setup, this doesn't matter. But if you intend to hand out different access levels to different people — full trust for close friends, limited access for casual guests — go to **Advanced: Config → User groups & bans** (Section 8.3) and change those other two passwords before you advertise your server publicly. Anyone who guesses a default password gets that group's permissions, which for Friend includes building/inventory access.

4.4 Once it's running

The Quick Setup tab shows you the query port to give out (default `15637`) — pass that, your public IP address (or dynamic DNS name — see Section 5), and the password to your friends. Section 5 covers exactly how they use it to connect.

5. Getting Your Friends Connected

The part that trips up almost every first-time host — and the part this manual can't do for you, since it happens on your router, not in the web panel.

5.1 Port forwarding

Enshrouded uses two adjacent ports: a UDP game-traffic port (default `15636`, derived as `queryPort − 1` — it isn't independently configurable) and a query port (default `15637`, this is the one that's configurable and the one that makes your server discoverable in the Steam server browser). Guidance on TCP vs UDP is inconsistent across hosting providers and router documentation, so the safe default is to forward **both ports, both protocols**:

```
Ports to forward:  15636–15637
Protocols:         TCP and UDP (both)
Forward to:        the LAN IP of the PC running the manager (e.g. 192.168.1.50)
```

1. Find the LAN IP address of the hosting PC (Windows: open Command Prompt, run `ipconfig`, note the `IPv4 Address`).
2. Log into your router's admin page (commonly `192.168.0.1` or `192.168.1.1` in a browser — check the label on the router itself if unsure).
3. Find the port forwarding section (sometimes called "Virtual Server," "NAT Forwarding," or "Applications & Gaming" depending on the router brand).
4. Add a rule forwarding ports 15636–15637 (TCP and UDP) to the hosting PC's LAN IP.
5. Save, and reboot the router if it asks you to — some models only apply forwarding rules after a restart.

> **TIP — GIVE THAT PC A FIXED LAN IP**
>
> If your router hands out IP addresses dynamically (DHCP, the default almost everywhere), the hosting PC's LAN IP can change after a reboot, silently breaking your forwarding rule. Either set a static IP on the PC itself, or use your router's "DHCP reservation" / "static lease" feature to always give that PC the same address.

5.2 If port forwarding doesn't seem to work

Re-check Section 2.3 first — CGNAT makes correct port forwarding rules simply not work, and it's a more common cause of "I did everything right and it still doesn't connect" than any router misconfiguration. Beyond that, a free "open port checker" tool (search for one, or use the one your router manufacturer links to) run against port 15637 from an external network will confirm whether the port is actually reachable from outside your house, which narrows down router misconfiguration vs. a firewall on the PC itself (Windows Defender Firewall will usually prompt to allow `enshrouded_server.exe` the first time it runs — approve that prompt if you see it) vs. CGNAT.

5.3 Dynamic DNS, if your home IP address changes

Most residential internet connections don't have a permanently fixed public IP address — it can change whenever your router reconnects. If you don't want to re-share a new IP address with friends every time that happens, a free dynamic DNS service (many router brands have one built in under a name like "DDNS"; third-party options are also widely available) gives you a fixed hostname (like `yourserver.example-ddns.net`) that automatically updates to point at your current IP. Give friends that hostname instead of a raw IP address.

5.4 How friends actually join

1. Open Steam and go to **View** → **Servers** to open the server browser.
2. Switch to the **Favorites** tab and click **Add a Server**.
3. Enter your address and query port together, e.g. `203.0.113.5:15637` (or `yourserver.example-ddns.net:15637` if using dynamic DNS), and confirm.
4. The server should now appear in the Favorites list — select it and click **Connect**.

5. Enshrouded will prompt for the password you set — this is where the group password from Section 4.3 / 8.3 comes in.

> **NOTE**
>
> Your server also becomes discoverable in the public Steam server browser (assuming the port is correctly forwarded and the server is running an up-to-date version — an outdated version can silently drop out of the browser listing). The Favorites method above is the reliable option regardless, and is what most private-group hosts use.

6. The Dashboard Tab

The one tab you'll actually use day-to-day.

6.1 Lifecycle controls

Three buttons — **Start**, **Stop**, **Restart** — plus a live readout of state, process ID, and uptime. Alongside it, a "Quick info" card shows the install directory, query port, slot count, and whether `enshrouded_server.json` has been generated yet.

6.2 Why Stop is a hard kill

> **CAREFUL**
>
> `enshrouded_server.exe` is a plain console application with no documented graceful-shutdown command — as far as could be confirmed, it doesn't listen for a clean-stop signal at all. **Stop** and **Restart** in this panel therefore hard-terminate the process. This isn't a bug in the manager; it's a real limitation of the game server binary itself. Enshrouded's own autosave runs on a rolling ~10-minute cycle regardless of how the process ends, which is your safety net — but it means up to ~10 minutes of world progress can theoretically be lost on a hard stop at the worst possible moment. The Backups tab (Section 9) gives you an independent second layer on top of that.

6.3 Live console

Streams the game server's own console output in real time (over the same WebSocket connection the status pill uses, so it updates live without refreshing the page). Handy for watching a startup succeed, or for spotting an error the moment it happens rather than digging through log files afterward.

7. Advanced: Setup / Install

Where things live on disk, and manual controls for SteamCMD.

Migrating an existing bat-file-launched server onto this manager? The card at the top of this tab can detect its install folder for you automatically — see Section 3.5.

7.1 Paths, and why install/SteamCMD are kept separate

SETTING	DEFAULT	PURPOSE
Install directory	`EnshroudedServer\server`	Where `enshrouded_server.exe` itself lands.
SteamCMD directory	`EnshroudedServer\steamcmd`	Where `steamcmd.exe` lives.
Backup directory	`EnshroudedServer\backups`	Where zipped save backups are written (Section 9).
Panel port	`8790`	What port the web panel itself listens on. Changing this needs a manual restart of the manager to take effect.

Each of the three folder fields above has its own **Browse…** button, which opens a normal Windows folder picker rather than making you type a path out by hand.

> **NOTE**
>
> These two install locations are kept apart on purpose. Running `steamcmd.exe` from inside the same folder you're installing the game into is a known way to make SteamCMD nest the game under `steamcmd\steamapps\common\...` instead of honoring the configured install directory — a confirmed real-world gotcha, not a hypothetical one. Leave these two paths separate unless you have a specific reason not to.

7.2 Manual SteamCMD controls

Quick Setup handles this automatically, but two buttons here let you install SteamCMD or install/update the game server on demand — useful for pulling a day-one patch without waiting for Quick Setup's full flow, or for re-running just the install step after changing paths above.

8. Advanced: Config

The full settings editor, once Quick Setup's defaults aren't enough.

> **NOTE**
> `enshrouded_server.json` doesn't exist until the server exe has actually launched successfully at least once — there's no command-line flag to pre-seed it. If it hasn't yet, this tab shows a banner offering to write a template you can edit in advance, or you can start the server once first (via Quick Setup or the Dashboard) and let the real file appear on its own.

8.1 Server settings

FIELD	NOTES
Name	Shown in the server browser.
IP bind	Default `0.0.0.0` (all network interfaces) — normally leave this alone.
Query port	Default `15637`. This is the port you give to friends and the one that needs forwarding (see Section 5).
Slot count	1–16.
Save / Log directory	Relative to the install directory by default (`./savegame`, `./logs`).
Voice / text chat	Toggle each on/off; voice chat mode is Proximity or Global — both already render as proper dropdowns, not free-text fields.
Gameplay preset	Default / Relaxed / Hard / Survival / **Custom** — see the warning below.

> **IMPORTANT — READ BEFORE TOUCHING THE GAMEPLAY TAB**
> The Gameplay settings below are **entirely ignored by the server unless this preset is set to exactly "Custom."** If you leave it on Default, Relaxed, Hard, or Survival, anything you change on the Gameplay tab is silently saved to the file but has zero in-game effect. This is a real behaviour of Enshrouded itself, not a bug in the panel — the UI reminds you of it next to the preset dropdown too.

8.2 Gameplay settings (Custom preset only)

Every field here is generated automatically from a schema, which is also why every setting with a fixed list of choices (weather frequency, spawner amount, fishing difficulty, aggro pool, taming startle behaviour, curse modifier, tombstone mode) already renders as a proper dropdown menu rather than something you have to type correctly — pick from the list, you can't enter an invalid value. Duration-style settings (day length, night length, hunger-to-starving time) are shown to you in **minutes** for convenience even though the real file stores them in nanoseconds — the panel converts both ways automatically. The full list of every setting, its default, and its allowed range is in Appendix A.

8.3 User groups & bans — read this before you go live

Enshrouded has no separate "admin login." Instead, whoever connects using a given group's password gets that group's permissions for the session. The manager ships three groups by default:

GROUP	DEFAULT PASSWORD	KICK/BAN	INVENTORIES	EDIT BASE	EXTEND BASE	RESERVED SLOTS
Admin	`changeme-admin`	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	1
Friend	`changeme-friend`	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	0
Guest	`changeme-guest`	No	No	No	No	0

SECURITY

As covered in Section 4.3, Quick Setup only overwrites the **Admin** password. If you're using the Friend or Guest groups at all, change their passwords here first — the names literally start with "changeme" as a reminder. You can add up to 10 groups total with the "+ Add group" button, each with its own independent permission set and an optional slot reservation (guaranteeing that many slots stay free for that group even when the server is otherwise full).

Bans work the same way in reverse: a player with kick/ban rights bans someone *in-game*, and the result shows up in the "Banned accounts" list here, which you can edit directly if needed. There is no remote/API way to kick or ban someone from the panel itself — see Section 12.

8.4 Raw JSON

Full, unrestricted control over the file, including a few top-level fields some third-party tools mention (`gamePort`, `bindIP`, a top-level `password`) that couldn't be confirmed against Keen's own documentation and were deliberately left out of the structured editor rather than guessed at. If your real generated file has them, this tab round-trips the entire JSON document — including any fields the structured tabs above don't know about — so nothing gets silently dropped when you save.

9. Advanced: Backups

A second, independent safety net on top of Enshrouded's own autosave.

9.1 How this differs from Enshrouded's own autosave

Enshrouded already keeps its own rolling set of 10 numbered save copies inside the save folder, refreshed roughly every 10 minutes. The Backups tab is a *separate* layer on top of that: it zips the entire save folder (including that internal rotation) into your configured backup folder, on your own schedule, independent of the game's own save cycle. This matters specifically because Stop/Restart are hard kills (Section 6.2) with no confirmed clean-shutdown path — relying on the engine's own autosave alone is riskier than also having an external copy you control.

9.2 Scheduling and restoring

SETTING	DEFAULT
Scheduled backups	**Off** — you need to turn this on explicitly.
Interval	60 minutes
Keep last N backups	10 (older ones are pruned automatically)

> **CAREFUL**
>
> Scheduled backups are **off by default**. If you want the safety net this tab provides, you need to turn it on yourself — it isn't automatic just because the manager is running.

"Back up now" runs an on-demand backup regardless of the schedule. Backups are named `savegame-<timestamp>.zip` and listed with size and creation time, each with **Restore** and **Delete** actions.

> **CAREFUL — RESTORING**
>
> Restoring requires the server to be stopped first, and it **overwrites your current save folder entirely**. Take a fresh backup before restoring an older one, just in case you want to undo the restore itself.

10. Advanced: Logs

Two different kinds of logs, both viewable without leaving the browser.

TYPE	SOURCE	USEFUL FOR
Manager-captured console	The exe's own stdout/stderr, captured by the manager since there's no other way to see what it printed after the fact.	Diagnosing a crash or a failed start after the fact.
Game logs	Whatever Enshrouded itself writes into its configured `logDirectory` (default `./logs` under the install dir) — only appears once the server has actually run.	Deeper in-game diagnostics from Enshrouded itself.

11. Troubleshooting

The manager doesn't start / no browser opens

The launcher waits up to 10 seconds for a PID file to appear, and if it doesn't, opens `data\manager.log` in Notepad automatically. That log captures everything printed on startup, including a crash before the manager's own logging would normally kick in — read the last few lines for the actual error.

"Node.js isn't installed" (source-mode only)

Only relevant if you're running from source rather than the release `.exe` (Section 3.2). Install the LTS version from nodejs.org; if you just installed it and still see this message, a restart of the PC is sometimes needed before Windows picks up the change.

SteamCMD keeps failing

The manager retries a SteamCMD failure automatically a few times before giving up, since a fresh SteamCMD install commonly needs to self-update on its first run before it can do anything else — this alone resolves most transient failures without you needing to click anything twice. If it still fails after retrying, check the log immediately above the failure for SteamCMD's own plain-English reason (a login/connection problem and a disk-space problem look different in the log, even though Valve has never documented the numeric exit codes themselves), and check your internet connection and firewall.

"enshrouded_server.exe not found"

The game hasn't been installed yet, or the configured install directory doesn't match where it actually landed. Run Quick Setup, or use the manual "Install / Update server" button on the Setup tab (Section 7.2).

The manager starts but data won't save / "permission denied"-style errors

Everything the manager creates is written next to the app itself rather than under `C:\` directly, specifically because a non-administrator Windows account often can't create new folders at a drive root — a silent permission failure that's a real candidate for "it just doesn't start." Keep the whole folder somewhere you already have write access (Desktop, Documents) rather than moving just the `.exe` into a protected system folder.

Config changes don't seem to do anything

Check the Gameplay preset first (Section 8.1) — it has to be exactly **Custom** for anything on the Gameplay tab to take effect at all.

Common in-game issues (not specific to this panel)

SYMPTOM	LIKELY CAUSE / FIX
Saves aren't persisting as expected	Steam Cloud can conflict with a locally-managed save folder. In Steam, go to Library → Enshrouded → Properties and turn Steam Cloud off, then restart.
"Connecting Anonymously to Steam Public... Retrying"	Usually a temporary Steam service issue. Wait 5–10 minutes; disabling auto-update in Settings has also been reported to help re-establish a connection.
Server not showing up in the Steam server browser	An outdated server version can silently drop out of the public listing — make sure you've run the latest update. It can also take a few minutes for the browser to refresh after an update. The Favorites method in Section 5.4 works regardless.

12. Known Limitations

Confirmed during research, not shortcomings of this panel — Enshrouded itself simply doesn't expose these.

- **No RCON, no admin console, no chat commands, no server-side REST API.** Kicking/banning a player or granting admin rights only happens in-game, via a connected player belonging to a group with kick/ban rights. The panel can edit the user-groups list and see the resulting ban list, but cannot kick anyone live or push a message into the game.
- **No confirmed graceful shutdown** — see Section 6.2.
- `enshrouded_server.json` **doesn't exist until the server has run once** — see Section 8.
- **No mod manager included.** Enshrouded has no official Workshop-style mod support; the community scene (Nexus Mods, the EML loader) is small and can be fragile across game updates. Install EML manually per its own instructions if you want mods.
- `gameSettings` **only applies when the preset is exactly "Custom"** — see Section 8.1.
- **Duration fields are stored in nanoseconds** in the real file — the panel converts to/from minutes for you on the Gameplay tab; the Raw JSON tab shows the true values.

13. Frequently Asked Questions

Can I run more than one Enshrouded server from the same manager?

Not from a single manager instance — it manages one install directory and one running process at a time. Running a second server means a second copy of the manager with its own panel port and install directory.

Do I need a Steam account to run the server?

No — the dedicated server installs and updates via anonymous SteamCMD login. A Steam account is only needed by the players connecting to it (to launch Enshrouded itself).

Can I access the panel from my phone?

Yes, from any device on the same home network — the manager listens on all network interfaces, not just the hosting PC itself, so `http://<hosting-PC's-LAN-IP>:8790` works from your phone on the same Wi-Fi. See the next question before doing this from outside your house.

> **SECURITY — DO NOT FORWARD THE PANEL PORT TO THE INTERNET**
>
> Port `8790` (or whatever you've changed it to) is the **management panel itself** — start/stop/restart, config editing, backups, all of it — and it has **no password or login of any kind**. Only forward the game's own ports (15636–15637, Section 5.1) through your router. Never add a forwarding rule for the panel port; doing so would let anyone on the internet control your server without needing any password at all.

What happens if the hosting PC restarts or loses power?

The manager doesn't currently start itself automatically on Windows boot — after a restart, you'll need to double-click **Enshrouded Server Manager.vbs** again yourself. (Windows' own "Startup" folder, or Task Scheduler's "run at log-on" option, can be pointed at the `.vbs` file if you want this automated — that's a Windows-level setting outside the manager itself.)

Can multiple people administer the same server?

Anyone with network access to the panel's port and no password prompt (see the security warning above) can use it — the panel itself has no per-user accounts. Treat access to the panel's URL as equivalent to having full control of the server.

APPENDIX A

Gameplay Settings Reference

Every field on the Gameplay subtab (Section 8.2) — remember, none of this has any effect unless the preset is set to **Custom**. Descriptions are based on each field's name and Keen's own documentation categories; exact underlying formulas aren't published by Keen.

SETTING	TYPE	DEFAULT	RANGE / OPTIONS	WHAT IT AFFECTS
`playerHealthFactor`	float	1	0.25–4	Multiplier on player max health.
`playerManaFactor`	float	1	0.25–4	Multiplier on player mana pool.
`playerStaminaFactor`	float	1	0.25–4	Multiplier on player stamina pool.
`playerBodyHeatFactor`	float	1	0.5–2	How quickly the player's body heat changes (cold-weather survival mechanic).
`playerDivingTimeFactor`	float	1	0.5–2	How long the player can stay underwater before needing air.
`enableDurability`	bool	true	on/off	Whether equipment/tools lose durability with use.
`enableStarvingDebuff`	bool	false	on/off	Whether going hungry applies a gameplay debuff.
`foodBuffDurationFactor`	float	1	0.5–2	Multiplier on how long food buffs last.
`fromHungerToStarving`	duration	10 min	2–60 min	Time from "hungry" to "starving" once food runs out.
`shroudTimeFactor`	float	1	0.5–2	Multiplier on how long the player can survive in the Shroud before taking its penalties.
`enableGliderTurbulences`	bool	true	on/off	Whether turbulence affects glider flight in the Shroud.
`weatherFrequency`	enum	Normal	Disabled / Rare / Normal / Often	How often weather events occur.
`randomSpawnerAmount`	enum	Normal	Few / Normal / Many / Extreme	Density of randomly-spawned enemies/resources from spawners.
`fishingDifficulty`	enum	Normal	VeryEasy / Easy / Normal / Hard / VeryHard	Difficulty of the fishing minigame.
`miningDamageFactor`	float	1	0.5–2	Multiplier on damage dealt while mining resource nodes.
`plantGrowthSpeedFactor`	float	1	0.25–2	Multiplier on how fast farmed plants grow.

SETTING	TYPE	DEFAULT	RANGE / OPTIONS	WHAT IT AFFECTS
`resourceDropStackAmountFactor`	float	1	0.25–2	Multiplier on the quantity of resources dropped when gathering.
`factoryProductionSpeedFactor`	float	1	0.25–2	Multiplier on crafting-station/production speed.
`perkUpgradeRecyclingFactor`	float	0.5	0–1	How much value is recovered when recycling/respeccing perk upgrades.
`perkCostFactor`	float	1	0.25–2	Multiplier on the cost of unlocking perks.
`experienceCombatFactor`	float	1	0.25–2	Multiplier on XP earned from combat.
`experienceMiningFactor`	float	1	0–2	Multiplier on XP earned from mining.
`experienceExplorationQuestsFactor`	float	1	0.25–2	Multiplier on XP earned from exploration and quests.
`aggroPoolAmount`	enum	Normal	Few / Normal / Many / Extreme	How many enemies can actively aggro at once.
`enemyDamageFactor`	float	1	0.25–5	Multiplier on damage dealt by enemies.
`enemyHealthFactor`	float	1	0.25–4	Multiplier on enemy health.
`enemyStaminaFactor`	float	1	0.5–2	Multiplier on enemy stamina.
`enemyPerceptionRangeFactor`	float	1	0.5–2	Multiplier on how far enemies can detect the player.
`bossDamageFactor`	float	1	0.2–5	Multiplier on damage dealt by bosses specifically.
`bossHealthFactor`	float	1	0.2–5	Multiplier on boss health specifically.
`threatBonus`	float	1	0.25–4	Multiplier affecting enemy threat/aggro generation.
`pacifyAllEnemies`	bool	false	on/off	Makes all enemies non-hostile (a peaceful/creative-style mode) when enabled.
`tamingStartleRepercussion`	enum	LoseSomeProgress	KeepProgress / LoseSomeProgress / LoseAllProgress	What happens to taming progress if the creature is startled.
`dayTimeDuration`	duration	30 min	2–60 min	Real-world length of an in-game day.
`nightTimeDuration`	duration	12 min	2–60 min	Real-world length of an in-game night.
`curseModifier`	enum	Normal	Easy / Normal / Hard	Overall difficulty of the game's curse/Shroud mechanics.

SETTING	TYPE	DEFAULT	RANGE / OPTIONS	WHAT IT AFFECTS
`tombstoneMode`	enum	AddBackpackMaterials	AddBackpackMaterials / Everything / NoTombstone	What's lost/recoverable from a player's tombstone on death.

APPENDIX B

Folder Layout

```
EnshroudedServerManager\
  Enshrouded Server Manager.vbs        Double-click to launch (silent, no window)
  Stop Server Manager.vbs              Double-click to stop the manager
  Start Server Manager (Show Log Window).bat   Same thing, visible window
  EnshroudedServerManager.exe          Release build \u2014 everything bundled in
  data\                                manager-settings.json, manager.pid,
                                        manager.log, captured console logs
  EnshroudedServer\
    server\                            enshrouded_server.exe + enshrouded_server.json
    steamcmd\                          SteamCMD itself, kept separate on purpose
    backups\                           Zipped save backups
```

The `data\` and `EnshroudedServer\` folders are created automatically on first run — nothing here needs to be created by hand.

APPENDIX C

Quick Reference Card

Ports

Game traffic (UDP)	`15636`
Query / join port	`15637`
Manager panel	`8790` — never forward this

Steam

App ID	`2278520`
Login	Anonymous

Defaults

Player slots	16 (hard max)
Backup interval	60 min (backups off by default)
Backup retention	10 copies
Enshrouded's own autosave	~10 min, 10 rolling copies

Default group passwords — change these

Admin	`changeme-admin`
Friend	`changeme-friend`
Guest	`changeme-guest`